



VATSSA DONATIONS POLICY

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VATSSA DONATION POLICY

1 POLICY INTRODUCTION

VATSSA is a volunteer-driven division of VATSIM, dedicated to providing a high-quality virtual air traffic control experience across the Southern Africa region. Like any organisation operating digital infrastructure, the division incurs real and ongoing costs in order to deliver its services to members.

This policy exists to govern the acceptance, management, and expenditure of voluntary financial contributions made by members of the VATSSA community. It sets out the principles under which donations are received, how funds are administered, and the mutual expectations between the division and those who choose to contribute.

This policy applies to all members of VATSSA, all members of staff, and any individual making a financial contribution to the division.

2 FINANCIAL CONTEXT

2.1 Why We Need Your Support

Running VATSSA involves real costs. Our infrastructure includes cloud-based virtual servers, DNS and security services, and the ongoing development and maintenance of our divisional platforms.

We are actively working to minimise these costs wherever possible, however some expenditure remains unavoidable in order to maintain a reliable and professional service for our members.

These costs are met entirely through the goodwill of our members. No VATSIM body allocates a budget to cover divisional running costs, which means that without voluntary contributions from people who care about the community we have built, services may be impacted. We are grateful to every member who chooses to contribute.

2.2 How We Spend Your Money

We take financial responsibility seriously. Before any expenditure is approved, staff are required to submit a formal funding request for central review. This ensures that every decision to spend donated funds is justified, transparent, and represents fair value.

A funding request must include:

- A clear description of what the funds are needed for
- The full cost involved
- A breakdown of what the division will receive in return
- Where applicable, a comparison of at least two service providers
- Any relevant quotes, invoices, or agreements already in place

This process applies to all divisional expenditure, whether recurring infrastructure costs or one-off items such as event support.

3 MAKING A DONATION

3.1 How to Contribute

Donations can be made through our official donation platform, details of which are available on the VATSSA website. By completing a donation, you confirm that you have read, understood, and accepted the terms set out in this policy.

VATSSA DONATION POLICY

3.2 What VATSSA Commits To

We believe transparency and integrity are essential to maintaining the trust of our community. In accepting your donation, VATSSA makes the following commitments:

- Funds will be used exclusively for divisional needs — no donation will be directed toward personal benefit or payment for voluntary work.
- All transactions are processed through our designated platform, providing an auditable record of income and expenditure.
- Any VATSSA member may request a summary of the division's annual finances, which will be shared by such a request.
- Your personal information will never be shared or disclosed in connection with your donation.
- Donors will not receive any form of preferential treatment, elevated status, or special consideration — within the division or otherwise.
- Any surplus funds will be retained and carried forward to support future operational needs.

3.3 What You Agree To

By donating to VATSSA, you acknowledge and accept the following:

- Your contribution is a voluntary act of goodwill. It does not entitle you to influence divisional decisions, policy, or appointments in any way.
- You will not reference your donation — publicly or privately — in a manner intended to pressure, influence, or gain favour with staff or fellow members.
- Your donation has no bearing on any disciplinary or conduct process conducted by a Supervisor,, or member of Staff.
- You will not publicise the fact that you have donated through any forum, social media platform, or other public channel.
- All donations are final. Once processed, contributions cannot be refunded or recalled under any circumstances.

4 POLICY ADMINISTRATION

4.1 Policy Owner

- Wian Saptouw, Division Director (VATSSA)

4.2 Policy Version History

Version	Date	Description	Author	Approver
1.0	26/04/2026	Initial Policy Drafted	George Daniel Schoonraad	Wian Saptouw